

COSMIC PULL TOWARDS EVOLUTION

Greetings, my dearest friends. Be blessed, every one of you. A great stream of divine strength and blessings is permeating you and is around you as a powerful force. Be aware of it, attune yourself to it, and you will perceive it as a reality. With its help, a deep understanding of this lecture will again enable you to make a step forward on your path toward finding yourself.

There is a great pull in the manifest universe in which you live. This pull is a part of the creative principle. Since every individual consciousness is also part of the same creative principle and is made of the same substance, as it were, this pull must exist in every human individual. This pull is directed toward union, as the term is usually used. But these terms, after a while, lose their meaning. What does union really mean? What does union with God, or with the divine part in the self, really mean? What does union with another individual mean? How does this apply to a human being living in this world?

First of all, the whole plan of evolution is concerned with uniting, with bringing together individual consciousness -- for only in this way can separateness be given up. Union with an abstract idea, with an intangible God, or as a cerebral process is not really union. Only the actual contact of one individual with another establishes those conditions in the entire personality that are the prerequisites for true inner union and unity. Therefore this pull manifests as a tremendous force, moving man toward others, making separateness painful and empty. The life force is therefore permeated not only with the pull towards others, but also with pleasure supreme. Life and pleasure are one. Unpleasure is the distortion of the life force and comes from opposing the creative principle. Life, pleasure, contact with others, oneness with others are the goal of the cosmic plan.

The pull aims to bring man out of his seclusion. It moves toward contact and melting. To follow and go with this cosmic pull is therefore blissful. It is an exhilaration and, at the same time, a peacefulness. However, individual consciousness opposes this pull. It opposes this pull due to the erroneous idea that by giving in to it the individual will be annihilated. Thus man puts himself in the paradoxical position of believing that life comes from opposing life.

Consequently man lives in a very deep conflict that transcends the psychological reasons and motivation to be found in the course of self-exploration. All these reasons are valid in themselves, as far as they go. They may be results of negative childhood experiences, of misinterpretations of events and their significance in childhood, of hurts and fears the person has not properly understood and assimilated. All this is true, and all this must be explored in order to meet and face a deeper universal, metaphysical conflict -- the one I am discussing here. The conflict exists because this pull cannot be eliminated. It is the evolutionary force itself which is the living reality in all that

lives and breathes. It permeates every particle of existence and must thus also exist in man's deep psyche whether he is aware of it or not.

The other side of the conflict is fear of and opposition to this pull; thus the personality stems against the natural flow. To the degree that the conscious and/or unconscious mind of man believes the goal and direction of the pull of the life force to be annihilation, to that degree will it apprehensively and forcefully stem against life itself. This is the most profound reason for man's misconceptions, his false fears and guilts, and his negativity and destructiveness. Deep within, he knows that he distrusts the greatest of spiritual forces and thus the life process itself. This constitutes a deep guilt which often manifests on surface levels in unjustified guilts he cannot abandon.

This conflict manifests practically and actually in a fear of his deepest instincts so that man cannot ever relax and be unguarded about himself. Since he is part of the life he distrusts, he must also distrust his own innermost self. This is why man proclaims, postulates, and insists upon a division between body and spirit -- and why the dualistic concept is perpetuated from generation to generation. Man seems to find his salvation in this very division because through it he can justify his rejection of the life principle as it manifests within himself. He thus stamps that which he fears to be dangerous and annihilating as wrong and bad, while he claims that the denial of his very nature is right and good. He justifies this irrational attitude by pointing to the most distorted manifestations of the life principle, of the pleasure current, as though this were proof of its badness. Thus he goes on, through the centuries, preaching that the body is sinful, while the spirit is supposed to be the opposite of the body and its forces, and therefore good.

It is erroneous to state that man's difficulties come from these misconceptions, these tragic errors he embraces as final truth and spirituality. It is more correct to state that these misconceptions are the product of this deep spiritual conflict which motivates man to accuse a part of the great spiritual principle of life of being the opposite of what it really is.

The abuse of this great powerful force by no means proves an inner acceptance of and trust in it. It is much rather one variation of the struggle that ensues when life is opposed in one's own nature. When one side pulls toward others and moves the personality to accept his instincts and his nature, but the other side shrinks back from this very movement, then deprivation, emptiness, meaninglessness, and a sense of waste ensue, which may in turn be overcompensated by a blind, rebellious, distorted abuse of these forces. This leads to pleasureless experience and seems to justify the sense of wrongness and danger. Here is truly a conflict and a struggle as of life and death. For this is what it seems all about.

There is a great deal of variety as to what extent and in what way this conflict manifests in individuals. But one thing can be said with certainty, the greater the conflict and the stronger the two opposite pulls -- giving in to the cosmic force and opposing it -- to that extent, pain and problems exist in man.

If man cannot allow himself freely, on the deepest level of his being, to flow with the cosmic stream, he must distort that same cosmic stream in him. Since he does not trust this cosmic force, and since he opposes it, and because this very same cosmic force manifests within his own deep self, he does not trust himself. For if he is to trust himself and his own innermost nature, he must first

trust this pull, which he can recognize easily. Therefore when man separates in his ideas nature from the divine principle, or his own innermost nature from spiritual trust, he is engaged in the greatest error, leading to the greatest of confusions. For how could nature, including the depth of man's own nature, be opposed to the divine evolutionary plan? It is only because of the counterpull in this struggle that layers come into existence which are untrustworthy and which seem to justify man's distrust of his instinctual self. Only the courage to explore and experience within himself these layers will yield the truth of an underlying core that is wholly trustworthy. But this, as I said, can only be experienced when the deep pull of nature, of evolution, of the creative principle is understood. The intellectual understanding is less important than the intuitive understanding which alone, though often with the initial help of intellectual concepts, will allow the individual to dissolve this conflict.

It is due to this conflict that the creative force cannot flow freely, but instead congests. In this congestion, it blocks the individual from partaking of the forces of nature as they are compatible with his total being and his own destiny. While man blocks and opposes this pull, he nevertheless cannot avoid it. It always leads toward contact with others. The fear of such contact leads some individuals, with whom this fear is very strong, into temporary withdrawal. As with everything else, withdrawal too can exist in many degrees. It can manifest in man's outer life and behavior, but it also manifests in a much more subtle and not so easily detectable form. That is, outwardly he may engage in contacts, but inwardly he remains uninvolved, isolated, separate. Whatever the degree, it cannot be maintained in the long run, for the isolation must become unbearable since nothing that opposes the life principle can be maintained. After all, the life principle represents ultimate reality, while fear of it is based on illusion. Illusion cannot be maintained indefinitely. The anxiety arising out of illusion and the illusory means to protect the self against an illusory danger can only be eliminated when this deep conflict is being understood and honored and when the personality finally allows himself to be in harmony with the creative principle.

As I said, even when the opposition is great, the pull toward contact and melting with another must remain, for it is a fundamental fact of creation. But the counterpull with its fear, distrust, and other destructive feelings that come into existence must then create negative contact. With all human beings, there is always some counterpull, even in relatively integrated and healthy individuals. If this were not so, they would not manifest as human beings in this particular form and dimension of consciousness. But let us take the individual whose counterpull is relatively weak and whose predominant personality affirms life and his own deepest instincts, and is therefore proportionately unconflicted. His experience and contact with others will be proportionately blissful and unproblematic. In terms of the last lecture, the pleasure principle will manifest in a most favorable way, which makes mutuality, genuine love, and pleasure supreme a living reality. To the degree the opposition to the cosmic pull creates blocks and congestions and the cosmic stream is thrown out of its natural mold, negative and painful contact must ensue. In terms of the last lecture, the pleasure principle will be attached to a negative situation born out of childhood experiences. This makes fulfillment an impossibility because the experience of pleasure is always threatened by the attached negativity. The individual thus becomes a helpless straw between the two pulls, being driven into painful contact, thus combining the two factors embodied in the two directions: (1) the pull toward contact, (2) the fear of it and hence a pull away from it. The latter engenders two fundamental defensive reactions, either the desire to hurt or the sense of being hurt, as an inevitable by-product of contact. Since the pleasure principle remains always present in the life stream, it then attaches itself to the distorted form in which contact takes place.

The greatest force in human life cannot be eliminated, but where it is distorted, the pleasure is negative. Since contact appears to hurt, pleasure manifests either in hurting or in being hurt -- in one form or another, to a greater or lesser degree. This cannot help but wind up in one of those vicious circles. The more painfully the pleasure principle in the cosmic pull manifests, the greater the fear, the apprehension, the guilt, the shame, the anxiety, the tension so that the opposition grows, the conflict increases, and the vicious circle continues.

The evolutionary problem for every existing and manifesting consciousness is therefore to deeply comprehend and to experience this fact of life, of creation, and not to misjudge the negative manifestation of contact and the pleasure principle. Man must go beyond it in an open attitude of search for his deepest nature, giving it a chance, as it were, and not take the negative emotions he encounters first as the last and ultimate reality of his instinctual life. The layer in which destructiveness, blind selfishness, dishonesty, as well as shameful attachments of the pleasure principle to negative situations, exist is not man's deepest nature. It is merely a demonstration, or a result, of this specific conflict, my friends. I cannot emphasize this strongly enough, for when he distrusts his innermost nature, man must distrust the whole spiritual universe. One cannot exist without the other. A point comes on the path toward liberation when the problem must be tackled from both ends. Only when man has the courage and honesty to face up to what he does not like in himself can he discover that the very energy and substance of these attitudes and traits is essentially constructive and trustworthy and can be converted by this realization and the deep desire to do so. Consequently, life's processes will become trustworthy and need no longer be opposed. Conversely, when man considers the possibility that the entire creative process may be trustworthy per se, he will develop the creative energy and divine substance and reconvert them into creativity.

It is impossible to trust God, to trust life, to trust creation, to trust nature if one distrusts one's own deepest innermost instincts. For where do these instincts come from? These instincts cannot be crushed, nor can they be denied, nor can they be uprooted, nor can they be forcefully superimposed with elements that are foreign to them and that seem, unreasonably, more palatable to the fearful soul. The only way out is to understand that these innermost instincts are good as such if they are not interfered with; they are part of the most divine power and not in the least opposite or hostile to spiritual growth. This is one of the most tragic errors of mankind -- tragic because nothing delays the evolutionary plan as much as this misconception held by otherwise quite enlightened individuals who are well-meaning but who do not see their own fears and errors. These instincts will prove themselves as bearers of light when they are not misjudged, fought against, denied, and split off from their divine origin in an artificial duality that presupposes the evilness of these instincts and regards them as the opposites of divine life, or spiritual life.

So man can only come into his own when he understands this and consequently ceases to fear and fight against himself, his instincts, his body, his nature -- and thus against nature as such. This is the great struggle of mankind. Once this is generally understood by all spiritual leaders, the individual struggle will be helped considerably. Not knowing this, continuing in the blind involvement of this struggle, makes the self incapable of relinquishing his separateness. Man thus bars himself from the completion of his innermost, most available, most immediate instincts as they exist in the physical and emotional realm. This peace between body and soul is an inevitable outcome and product of self-realization. It is erroneous to believe that the body can simply be left

aside in the great venture of integration. When the body is shed without this integration having taken place, it is a work that still remains to be accomplished.

The depth and the universality of this conflict are evident when it is observed that often the most enlightened, evolved, and otherwise unprejudiced individuals become uneasy when they are to meet this conflict in themselves. Even if they do not conform to small-minded and life-denying views, this deep inner anxiety, stemming from this conflict, induces them to make themselves blind to what goes on within. Whenever man is not courageous in facing this conflict as it manifests nakedly deep down in the recesses of the self, he remains isolated to some extent. He remains involved in painful negativity and split within himself until his further evolution brings him to the point when he no longer fears the great stream of which he is a part and of which is part of himself -- which leads him toward others and which dissolves the wall of separateness and of defenses. He will then find that not only does he not lose his individuality, but, quite to the contrary, he expands it and becomes more himself.

Now I would like to discuss one of the many aspects of the human personality, which seems relatively insignificant in comparison to the topic of this lecture. It seems no more than a mere "psychological" facet, relatively superficial. Yet it has a deep meaning and connection, which I will point out later. This aspect is frustration. As all human attitudes, it can be easily distorted into two opposites, both equally undesirable and destructive. Everyone knows that the inability to stand frustration constitutes a severe disturbance of the personality and impairs the character of the individual. It inflicts pain on the self and on others when frustration cannot be handled, when the traits that make such handling impossible are prevalent. These are greed, self-centeredness, blindness, fear. The falsely enlightened person, in order to avoid these pitfalls, postulates resignation, martyrdom, and abstinence in order to learn the great, important attitude of inner relaxation.

It is by no means true that the only alternatives are intense insistence, rigid and unbending demands, or renunciation of happiness, fulfillment, gratification. Both extremes are in equal error, leading to very similar results and stemming from the identical underlying problem.

For obvious reasons, the wrong attitude about frustration is harmful. It impairs relationships, self-respect, and inner peace; apart from these reasons, I shall now discuss it from the point of view of the pleasure principle. The infant, striving for its pleasure, is, in its blindness, incapable of standing frustration because it ignores the possibilities of the future. When maturity is not gained, the same attitude continues within the psyche. A peculiar apparent contradiction ensues. The less frustration can be endured, the less the pleasure that can exist. The rigidly insisting person loses the pleasure he strives for either because the very nature of his striving makes the attainment impossible or, even when he succeeds, the nature of his inner state makes the experiencing of pleasure impossible. Thus he cannot win. In order to experience pleasure, a relaxed inner state must exist; a flexible climate must prevail; a life-affirming, positive, inclusive attitude is necessary. The person who, inwardly or outwardly, rebels against the absence of immediate gratification is angry, exclusive, negative, tense, stubborn. These are all traits that defeat the life principle and the pleasure stream. It is man's error to assume that what he wants is more important and pleasure-producing than his state of mind.

When the importance of being able to stand frustration is misunderstood, martyrdom, abstinence, resignation, no matter under what "spiritual" guise, makes the attainment of pleasure impossible. Hopelessness sets in, as well as waste. Since pleasure is a by-product of the cosmic stream, it cannot possibly be said that it is unimportant. But the insistence and rigidity, revealing a sense of "do or die," are equally erroneous.

Only when an individual learns the relaxed soul movement of letting go, of allowing the self not to have its own way right now, but without abandoning fulfillment as such, then and then only is the necessary climate established which allows the cosmic flow to stream forth. In other words, every individual has to reach for the inner experience in which he can feel himself letting go and relaxing in this letting go -- not relinquishing forever, but relaxing into pleasure just by the power of the gentle letting go. These words will be obscure or even contradictory if this feeling has never been experienced. But those of you who have occasionally had an inkling of it will know of the power and the reality of what I am saying and will harken to it in a conscious and deliberate way.

When I speak of this attitude or this soul movement or pleasure, it applies to anything, on all levels of existence. It may apply to any little or big wish, any fulfillment you desire. If you feel inwardly tense and are unwilling to relax it through an attitude of wise, positive, constructive outlook, reasonableness, fairness, and humility, while yet knowing and reaching for complete fulfillment, you separate yourself further from feeling good. But often the temptation to remain in this tense state is great, for the anger and self-pity seem a substitute gratification. It requires the ego's most constructive inner effort to let go of this. It is often only one tiny point one moves away from, "one tiny point of effort." Then it follows by itself, and the ego is carried by the inner forces that must be activated in order to follow through. Once the tension is abandoned, pleasure ensues through the very attitude described. The flexibility of relaxing into what is, even if what is at the moment is not what you want, must ultimately bring you what you want -- first of all by giving you a good feeling about yourself and also by being in harmony with the cosmic soul movement within your psyche. Later, also, the thing you want will come, must come, as a matter of course, following the law of cause and effect.

This is the climate which is essential in order to establish the inner knowledge that all fulfillment is potentially yours and can actually be yours through your knowing this. But only when you know this in an atmosphere of letting go, of unintensity, can it become true. When you are in a state of "I must have," it cannot come true. For the tension itself is hostile to the vibration necessary to bring you into harmony with all fulfillment as it already exists as a potential to be realized.

These ideas are not easy to grasp when you first hear them. They will require study, not only study in thinking about them, but, what is even more essential, seeing in what way you yourself are inwardly tense about not getting your way. Or perhaps you have embraced the opposite extreme of resignation. This is only the reverse side of the same coin. When you see either one of these attitudes, or both of them, fluctuating, then can you proceed to claim inwardly, to reach for the experience that I described: letting go, relaxing into the pleasure of the movement of letting go. Little by little, you will remove the blocks that tighten you up.

The topic of frustration is directly linked with what I said first. When man blocks the stream of the creative principle which brings him into the pleasure supreme of giving up separateness, he

frustrates himself on the most important level of his life. If this were not so, he would not ever have to fear frustration, unfulfillment, emptiness, being shortchanged by life. Since man fears the fulfillment of the cosmic stream and blocks it, there must inevitably exist, at the same time, the fear of nonfulfillment. The inability to stand frustration is a result of fearing nonfulfillment. Fearing nonfulfillment exists to precisely the degree the inner person stems against fulfillment. The importance of these connections is immeasurable.

This applies to everything in man's life. Of course, it primarily and fundamentally applies to the great issue of cosmic union with another person, of trusting and following one's own deep instinctual nature and consequently the experiencing of the highest state of bliss available for man. It also applies to mental issues, to the levels of accomplishment, of mundane everyday life. The often experienced fear of failure is a result of fearing success. Success vaguely seems as dissolving and dangerous as any fulfillment or happiness. Fear of the smaller happinesses is a minor manifestation of the fear of the major happiness that ensues when man no longer fears the instinctual forces. If the individual fears fulfillment, he blocks it and thus makes it impossible so that he justifiably fears nonfulfillment. Consequently, he cannot endure the emptiness and struggles against any frustration. The adamant insistence not to be frustrated expresses "I want to be happy and feel good without having to give myself in trust and willingness to the universe as it manifests in me." This is, of course, an utter impossibility.

Frustration could not be an issue if the cosmic flow were understood and accepted and one's own innermost nature were not a feared force one resists and fights. Try, my friends, to feel these things in your very personal life, and work with them.

Now are there any questions regarding this topic, my friends?

QUESTION: What is this inner pull you are talking about? I don't quite understand.

ANSWER: It is a pull toward another individual, toward an expression of the instinctual forces, toward an integration of these instinctual forces with one's conscious mind and with one's concepts and with one's acceptance of life, of self, and of others.

QUESTION: You discussed the cosmic pull that becomes negative in the individual at a certain period of his development. Could you explain this more?

ANSWER: When a person opposes his cosmic pull and struggles against it, conflict exists. The original pull always remains the greater power since it is a primary cosmic force, while the struggle against it is a superimposed secondary and weaker force so that man is still pulled towards contact. But the contrary force in him denies and negates the primary force so that the negation combines with the original movement and force. Thus negative contact ensues. The actual contact taking place is an expression of the pull toward others; the pain arising from it is an expression of the counterpull. To the degree fear of the cosmic pull and its destiny exists, love -- which can only grow in a climate of fearlessness -- must be absent from the contact. The fear produces defenses, hurts, anger -- all these enter into the contact and combine with the pleasure principle as I discussed before.

This manifests on any level of the personality. Negative contact that manifests in the desire to hurt expresses itself in everyday life in quarrelsomeness, hostility, aggression. On the sexual level, such an individual is sadistic. Negative contact that manifests in being hurt expresses itself in everyday life in a tendency to be taken advantage of. He will always manage to put himself at a disadvantage. He will be driven into behavior patterns damaging for him. On the sexual level, such an individual is masochistic. Now, of course, it must be understood it is never one versus the other. There are always both elements represented in a personality, but only one of them may be predominant and on the surface. For example, just because a person fears his cruelty, his need to derive pleasure from hurting others, he may reverse it and direct it to himself. The same applies to the other extreme. Since all this takes place on a blind, unconscious level, the person does not know what he is doing. He does not know how he is driven and is therefore unable to stop the destructive process.

This lecture is destined to make you understand that the psychological aspects have a much deeper origin than what is usually assumed in mundane psychology. This deeper origin is this profound, metaphysical conflict in all human beings. When this is perceived and experienced, it is much easier to eliminate the psychological distortions that appear to have originated in this life. On the other hand, it must also be realized that this cannot be experienced, the cosmic struggle cannot become even vaguely conscious, unless a person has considerable insight and awareness of his unconscious.

I have given you a topic with which you can again, if you choose to do so, make a deep inroad into your innermost self. Use it, explore it, do not fear your innermost self. If man runs away from his innermost self, it is the more tragic because he inflicts upon himself so much unnecessary error, so much unnecessary pain. Nothing else can ever create such pain as running away from the self. You have nothing to fear, nothing whatever. At all times look deep into yourself without defensiveness, without apprehension, without anxiety. And the more you look into yourself, the more equipped you will be to establish contact with others. The more you run away from yourself, the more superficial, troublesome, or unsatisfactory such contact must be. Be in peace, my friends, be blessed, be in God!

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